



INVESTPUPPY

Brand Voice Guide

How InvestPuppy communicates. What the voice is, what it is not, and how to apply it consistently across every touchpoint — from first contact to due diligence to internal communications.

Every person who communicates on behalf of InvestPuppy or Vektor should read this document before writing anything.

THE INVESTPUPPY STANCE

Before the principles. Before the voice. The posture that produces both.

“There’s got to be a better way...”

This philosophy was not assembled from a marketing guide. It was not learned from a textbook or arrived at through brand workshops.

It evolved from decades of experiencing the traditional way — the overselling, the selective disclosure, the capability claims that outran the evidence — and thinking, every time: there must be a better way.

The InvestPuppy Stance is what happens when the people who built this platform decided to do the opposite of everything that frustrated them as practitioners. Not as a positioning strategy. As a professional conviction built over years, in rooms where the wrong way was the standard way.

Vektor exists for the same reason. Not because a market opportunity was identified — because a professional frustration became a decision.

That is where the honesty comes from.

WHEN CRITICISM ARRIVES

When criticism arrives — from the market, from a prospect, from a reviewer, from your own honest assessment — the InvestPuppy response is not to defend, redirect, or minimise. It is to ask a different question:

“What does this give us?”

The name was a problem. It became the most memorable signal in the category. The absence of a track record was a vulnerability. It became the most trusted sentence in the suite. The limitations of the current product were risks to manage. They became a document that no competitor will write.

This is not optimism. It is method. Every criticism contains information. Most firms suppress that information. InvestPuppy uses it.

This is where the honesty comes from. Not from a commitment to transparency in the abstract — but from a genuine conviction that what is true, including what is uncomfortable, is always more useful than what sounds good.

01 See it clearly.

Do not look away from a criticism. Do not minimise it. Do not redirect toward something more comfortable. The criticism is information. Treat it as such.

02 Own it completely.

No qualifying, no deflecting, no "but on the other hand". If the criticism is valid, say so directly. The InvestPuppy name. The absent track record. The current equity-only scope. All owned, all stated first, all without apology.

03 Ask what it gives you.

This is the step that separates the stance from ordinary honesty. Not just: what do we do with this criticism? But: what does this criticism make possible that defensiveness would not? Every time InvestPuppy has asked this question, the answer has been better than the alternative.

THE FOUNDATION

The stance produces one governing principle.

HONEST BY DESIGN

Say the uncomfortable thing first. Capability claims follow evidence, not precede it. Acknowledge limitations before they are asked about. Answer the hard question directly. Never present a selective version of the truth.

This is not a communications strategy. It is a behavioural standard. Every document, every conversation, every message should pass a single test: 'Are we being as honest here as we are capable of being?'

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR INVESTPUPPY SPECIFICALLY

Boutique DPMS, family office principals, and independent wealth managers have been oversold to their entire careers. Their default posture in any vendor conversation is: *what are they not telling me?* The InvestPuppy voice resolves this before it forms. By the time a prospect reaches the due diligence stage, the answer to that question should already be: *nothing. They told us everything, including the things we didn't ask about.*

Honesty is also the brand characteristic that cannot be replicated without actually being honest. A competitor can copy the methodology. They cannot copy a culture of institutional integrity that is visible in every communication from day one.

TEN PRINCIPLES

PRINCIPLE 01

Honest before impressive.

Lead with what is true, including what is inconvenient. Capability claims come after evidence, not before it. If the full picture includes a limitation, include the limitation first.

✓ DO

- We don't yet have a live track record. Here is what we have instead.
- 99.94% is an operational metric. It is not a performance claim.
- Vektor currently supports listed equities only.

✗ DON'T

- Vektor delivers exceptional risk-adjusted returns.
- Our proprietary AI generates market-beating signals.
- The most advanced platform in its class.

PRINCIPLE 02

Specific, not general.

Replace every vague claim with a precise one. If you cannot be specific, you probably should not be making the claim.

✓ DO

- 10,000 portfolio configurations map the efficient frontier.
- 99.94% capital allocation efficiency at live prices.
- 6 indicators per instrument, 3-year daily history, XGBoost validation.

✗ DON'T

- Highly efficient capital deployment.
- Rigorous signal selection methodology.
- Sophisticated risk management framework.

PRINCIPLE 03

Confident without apology.

State limitations directly and move on. Do not apologise for the company name, the stage of development, the scope of the product, or the honest answer to a hard question. Confidence and honesty are not in tension.

✓ DO

- Vektor does not yet have a live track record.
- Yes, the company is called InvestPuppy.
- We are currently in IBKR simulation mode.

✗ DON'T

- We acknowledge that our limited history may be a concern...
- Despite the unconventional name...
- While we are still in early stages...

PRINCIPLE 04

Pre-emptive, not reactive.

Raise the difficult question before it is asked. Answer the objection before the prospect forms it. The document 'What Vektor Is Not' exists for this reason.

✓ DO

- We recommend reading WP-09, which covers what can go wrong.
- We do not yet support fixed income or alternatives.
- Here are the scenarios under which this approach underperforms.

✗ DON'T

- — (silence on limitations, waiting to be asked)
- As with any systematic approach, results may vary.
- Past performance is not indicative of future results.

PRINCIPLE 05

Dry, not breathless.

No exclamation marks. No superlatives. No 'exciting', 'revolutionary', 'game-changing', or 'cutting-edge'. Let the content generate the excitement. If the content requires amplification to be impressive, the content is not impressive.

✓ DO

- The platform runs 10,000 portfolio configurations per strategy.
- Multi-mandate is live. Different clients, different mandates, concurrently.
- One Size Fits None.

✗ DON'T

- We are thrilled to introduce the most exciting development in...
- Vektor is revolutionising the way boutique DPMs...
- Our cutting-edge, game-changing systematic approach!

TEN PRINCIPLES (CONTINUED)

PRINCIPLE 06

Irreverent about ourselves, rigorous about the work.

The company is called InvestPuppy. The methodology is documented across ten research papers. Both things are simultaneously true and neither undermines the other. The name is not an apology and the rigour is not a defence. They simply coexist.

✓ DO

- Yes, we're called InvestPuppy. Vektor is the platform.
- Serious when it matters.
- The work speaks for itself. The name is a signal about how we see ourselves.

✗ DON'T

- Despite the name, we are a serious firm.
- InvestPuppy — don't let the name fool you.
- We know the name is unusual for an institutional product...

PRINCIPLE 07

Evidence-anchored.

Every claim has a backing reference. The white paper series exists precisely for this purpose. Use it. 'We believe' and 'we think' are acceptable for opinions. For facts and methodology, cite the evidence.

✓ DO

- See: WP-01 — Quantitative Portfolio Construction.
- The 99.94% figure is documented in the brochure with methodology.
- Signal selection is described in full in WP-02.

✗ DON'T

- We believe our methodology is among the most rigorous available.
- Our approach is based on proven quantitative techniques.
- The platform is designed with institutional-grade precision.

PRINCIPLE 08

Human voice, not corporate voice.

'We' not 'the company' or 'the platform'. Direct address, active voice, present tense. Write as a person who knows what they are talking about, not as a firm that needs to sound official.

✓ DO

- We will run the full workflow on your data.
- Ask us. We will tell you.
- Show us a mandate. We'll show you the platform.

✗ DON'T

- InvestPuppy is committed to delivering value to its clients.
- The platform is designed to provide wealth management professionals with...
- Vektor's proprietary methodology enables users to...

PRINCIPLE 09**Short, then deep.**

First contact should be one page or five slides. Due diligence should be ten white papers. Never reverse this. The depth exists to reward those who earned it, not to overwhelm those who have not yet decided to care.

✓ DO

- At a Glance: one page. White papers: ten volumes.
- Lightning Deck: six slides. Technical Deep Dive: fifteen.
- FAQ first. White papers if they ask.

✗ DON'T

- Here is our comprehensive 46-document suite for your initial review.
- We've prepared an extensive overview covering all aspects of...
- To fully understand the platform, please read the following twelve documents.

PRINCIPLE 10**Complete, not selective.**

If honest communication requires including something uncomfortable, include it. Selective truth is not honesty. The test is not 'does this help our case?' but 'does this give the reader what they need to make an informed decision?'

✓ DO

- WP-09 covers market regime risk in detail.
- We have listed all open items in our outstanding register.
- The Founding Mandate Programme is honest about what we are offering and why.

✗ DON'T

- We focus on our strengths in all client communications.
- — (omitting known limitations from due diligence materials)
- All relevant information is available on request.

APPLYING THE VOICE

CONTEXT	AUDIENCE	VOICE NOTE
FIRST CONTACT	EXTERNAL	Bold layer. Lead with the name, the proof-of-concept offer, or the 'What Vektor Is Not' document. Personality visible from the first sentence. No product detail until asked.
COMMERCIAL DOCUMENTS	EXTERNAL	Confident, specific, evidence-anchored. Brochure, Why Vektor, Founding Mandate Programme. Claims supported by white paper references throughout.
DUE DILIGENCE	EXTERNAL	Conservative layer. Rigour, evidence, complete disclosure. Limitations stated without apology. References to WP-09 and risk disclosure are features, not footnotes. No personality amplification here.
WHITE PAPERS	EXTERNAL	Technical and precise. Evidence-anchored throughout. Readable by a non-quant practitioner but rigorous enough for a quant. Never promotional. The work speaks for itself.
INTERNAL DOCUMENTS	INTERNAL	Same honesty standard as external. Internal documents that suppress bad news or overstate progress are a failure of the brand principle, not just a management problem.
ANY COMMUNICATION	ALL	If you are unsure whether something passes the voice standard, apply the single test: 'Are we being as honest here as we are capable of being?' If the answer is no, rewrite it.

Honest by design. Every sentence, every document, every time.

The audience will know the difference. Make sure they do.